DELETING BLOG POSTS CAN HELP YOUR STORE RANK

If you do it right. Here's the framework

Content audit · /blog

/blog/how-to-choose-running-shoes	KEEP
/blog/best-running-shoes-2023	REFRESH
/blog/trail-shoes-guide	MERGE
/blog/trail-running-shoes-tips	MERGE
/blog/summer-sale-2021	REDIRECT
/blog/company-picnic-photos	REMOVE

KEEP REFRESH MERGE REDIRECT REMOVE

SWIPE →



Muhammad Mehrooz Shafique
Co-Founder, Permanent SEO

PERMANENT SEO

THE PROBLEM

Thin, outdated and overlapping posts **split your signals and waste crawl budget.**

Trail shoes guide
Overlaps

Trail running shoes tips
Overlaps

Best shoes 2021
Outdated

Shoe news (120 words)
Thin

Split signals
Two posts compete for one query

Wasted crawl budget
Googlebot spends time on pages nobody needs



Muhammad Mehrooz Shafique
Co-Founder, Permanent SEO

THE WRONG WAY

Bulk-deleting everything with low traffic. **You lose links, seasonal pages and context.**

~~**Black Friday gift guide**~~
Seasonal · 0 clicks in June

× Deleted

~~**Old buying guide**~~
12 backlinks

× Deleted

~~**Care tips**~~
Linked from 30 products

× Deleted

Lost backlinks

Lost seasonal pages

Lost context



Muhammad Mehrooz Shafique
Co-Founder, Permanent SEO

STEP 1 — EXPORT THE DATA

12–16 months of GSC clicks + impressions, **plus backlinks per URL.**

Search Console + backlinks · last 16 months

URL	Clicks	Impr.	Links
/blog/how-to-choose-running-shoes	[X]	[X]	[X]
/blog/best-running-shoes-2023	[X]	[X]	[X]
/blog/trail-shoes-guide	[X]	[X]	[X]
/blog/summer-sale-2021	[X]	[X]	[X]

12–16 months of data · placeholder values

KEEP

Gets clicks, still accurate, **matches search intent.**

KEEP `/blog/how-to-choose-running-shoes`

- ✓ **Gets clicks**
- ✓ **Still accurate**
- ✓ **Matches search intent**



Muhammad Mehrooz Shafique
Co-Founder, Permanent SEO

REFRESH

Was strong, now declining or out of date. **Update facts, products, examples.**

BEFORE

Best running shoes 2023

Clicks falling · old models

REFRESHED

Best running shoes 2027

- ✓ Updated facts
- ✓ Current products
- ✓ New examples



Muhammad Mehrooz Shafique
Co-Founder, Permanent SEO

07 / 10

ACTION 3 OF 5

MERGE

Two or more posts competing for the same query. **Combine into the strongest URL.**

Trail shoes guide
Competes for “trail running shoes”

Trail running shoes tips
Competes for “trail running shoes”

↓ combine

STRONGEST URL

`/blog/trail-running-shoes-guide`

+ 301 from the weaker post



Muhammad Mehrooz Shafique
Co-Founder, Permanent SEO

PERMANENT SEO

REDIRECT OR REMOVE

Has links or a better page exists → 301. **No traffic, no links, no relevance → remove.**

REDIRECT

Has links **or** a better page exists

`/blog/summer-sale-2021`

301

`/collections/sale`

REMOVE

No traffic, no links, no relevance

`/blog/company-picnic-photos`

404 / 410



Muhammad Mehrooz Shafique
Co-Founder, Permanent SEO

AFTER PRUNING

Fix internal links to old URLs, update the sitemap, **re-check in 8 weeks.**

1

Fix internal links

Point links at the new URL, not the old one

2

Update the sitemap

Remove old URLs, keep only live ones

3

Re-check in 8 weeks

Compare clicks and indexing in GSC

Week 0 · prune **Week 8 · review**



Muhammad Mehrooz Shafique
Co-Founder, Permanent SEO

PERMANENT SEO

10 / 10

FREE SHEET

GET THE SHEET · COMMENT

“PRUNE”

for the **Content Pruning Decision Sheet**

CONTENT PRUNING DECISION SHEET

URL	Clicks	Links	Decision
[URL]	[X]	[X]	KEEP
[URL]	[X]	[X]	REFRESH
[URL]	[X]	[X]	MERGE
[URL]	[X]	[X]	REDIRECT
[URL]	[X]	[X]	REMOVE

+ Follow **Follow Muhammad Mehrooz Shafique**



Muhammad Mehrooz Shafique
Co-Founder, Permanent SEO

PERMANENT SEO